

Verifying the statutory registers

Two procedures: one for you, one for the compliance officer.

NeevTime produces the muster roll, overtime register and leave register from attendance it collected. The content is right — every figure traces to punches in the database, and the calculations are tested. What has never been checked is whether the **layout** satisfies an inspector, because form numbers and column orders are set by each state's Factories Rules and differ: Form 25 in Tamil Nadu, Form 29 in Maharashtra, others elsewhere.

That is a claim about a document, and it is settled by a person who has sat through an inspection reading one month of real output. Until then, the honest position is "the record is complete; the form may need laying out differently" — which is what the product says on the page.

Procedure A — what you do (about 20 minutes)

A1. Generate one real month

Attendance → Reports → Statutory Registers. Pick a complete month that has already ended, with the full workforce in it. Not the current month — a partial month invites questions about missing days that are simply not over yet.

Export all three:

Register	Retention required	What it shows
Muster roll	3 years	one row per worker, one mark per day
Overtime register	5 years	one row per worker per day with overtime
Leave register	5 years	approved leave over the period

A2. Read them yourself first

Two minutes, and it saves the officer's time for the questions only they can answer:

- Does every current employee appear on the muster roll?
- Do people who left mid-month appear, with — after their last day?
- Does any row show ? for a whole run of days? That means the system was not

collecting then, and you should be able to say why before being asked.

A3. Send them with the gaps stated

Do not present these as certified forms. Send the three exports, this document, and say plainly:

> These are generated from our attendance system. The content is complete; we > have not verified the layout against the Form our state prescribes, and one > field a strict muster roll wants — the worker's father's or husband's name — > is not held in the system at all. We would like you to mark up what an > inspector would object to.

Stating the two known gaps up front is not weakness. An officer who finds them unaided will wonder what else was not mentioned.

A4. Act on what comes back

Column order and headings are layout, and cheap to change. A missing **field** is different: it means data nobody is currently collecting, and someone has to decide whether to start. Send the marked-up copy back and it becomes a change to the product, not a discussion.

Procedure B — what the compliance officer does

Hand this section, and one month of exports, to whoever knows your state's Factories Rules.

You are being asked one question: **would an inspector accept these, and if not, exactly what is wrong?** Not whether the numbers are right — they come from biometric punches and are tested — but whether the document is the one the Rules require.

B1. The form itself

For each of the three registers, against the Form your state prescribes:

- Is the **Form number and title** required on the page? Which one?
- Are the **columns the prescribed ones**, in the prescribed order?
- Are any **required columns missing entirely**?
- Are any columns present that should not be?
- Is a **certification or signature block** required at the foot? Whose?
- Is any **establishment header** required — factory name, licence number,

address, period?

B2. The muster roll specifically

- Are the **day marks** acceptable? Currently: **P** present, **A** absent, **L** leave, **H** holiday, **W** weekly off, **—** not employed on that date, **?** no data recorded anywhere that day.
- Does your state require different letters, or a different treatment of a

half day?

- **Father's or husband's name** is not held by the system and cannot be

printed. How strictly is that enforced in practice, and is it required on the muster roll or only on the wage register?

- Should workers who **left mid-period** appear at all? They currently do, on the reasoning that a muster roll for a past period is a record of who worked then.

B3. The overtime register

- Is a **rate and computed amount** required? The system deliberately shows hours only, because it does not hold wage rates and a computed figure from a rate nobody entered would be a number somebody relies on.
- Is overtime required **per day**, or aggregated per week or per month?
- Is a **reason for overtime** a required column?

B4. The leave register

- Are **leave types** required to be named as the Rules name them (earned, casual, sick), and do ours map onto those?
- Is an **opening and closing balance** required, or only leave taken?

B5. Mark-up sheet

Please return this filled in, or annotate the printouts directly — whichever is faster for you.

#	Register	What is wrong	What the Rule requires instead	Layout or missing data?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

And one line at the end that matters more than the table:

> **Would you produce these at an inspection as they stand?** Yes / No — and if > no, the single change that would most change that answer: > >

What happens to your answer

Layout corrections go into the product and every customer gets them. A missing field becomes a decision about what to start collecting — which is a conversation with whoever runs HR, not a code change.

Either way it converts "we believe these are compliant" into "a compliance officer has read a month of these and marked them up", which is the difference between a claim and a reference.